

# The Reminiscence - The Monologues of Being Seen

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## 1 PROJECT URL

<http://sjameslee.com/project/reminiscence2022/>

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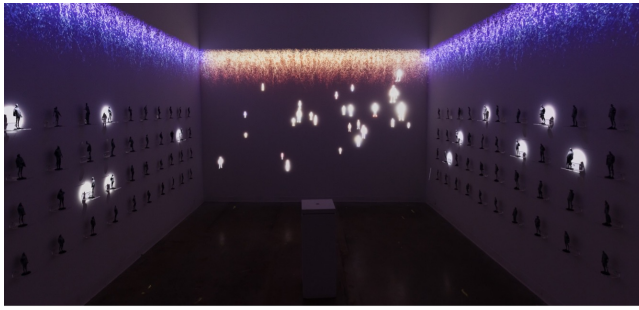
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## 2 DESCRIPTION OF ARTWORK

The Reminiscence - The Monologues of Being Seen is the third-generation interactive media installation based on the Posture Portraits Project (PPP). PPP is an interdisciplinary project which examines how bodies have historically been created/made through scientific interventions and surveillance while simultaneously engaging with the concept of inclusivity of all bodies including those traditionally seen as “Other.” To do so, we trace the development of healthism - the reinforcement of certain norms that construct the “healthy” as moral and pure and the “unhealthy” as foreign and polluted - in the modern American university which dates back to the early 17th century, and its relationship to the U.S. eugenics movement in the late 19th to 20th century. We explore how these ideologies were mobilized in the service of creating new disciplining and surveillance technologies in higher education by examining



the case of what is known as “the posture portraits.” These portraits, taken at colleges and universities across the nation during the 1920s-1960s, were used as a measurement of ability and good posture, which at that time, was linked to intelligence, beauty, and what it meant to be “normal.” Most evidence of this malpractice was purged from the archives as if it had never happened.

Our first attempt was to invite the current generation of students, share the story, and ask them to try this practice in their way. We captured photos and 3D data and created our first interactive installation in 2018. Then, we made the second generation that aimed to create an immersive and participatory performance in 2021. The latter performance included dancers on-site, and they shared their personal experiences of being seen. At each performance, we collected data from participants as well. Finally, our third generation was designed to be a standalone exhibit to present all our previous work as a whole including new generations’ reflections and monologues of being seen: personal stories of what it is like to be seen by others. Overall, we had more than two hundred participants and collected their data. In the third iteration, we included about 100 data sets and sculptures. A visitor can look around at 1/10 scale individual sculptures and retrieve individual data sets and visual audio experience by placing a sculpture on the center platform where the system detects the id of each sculpture and triggers visualization and audio rendition.

### 3 ARTIST INFORMATION

Sangyoon Lee is a computer scientist and media artist interested in computer graphics, visualization, games, physical computing, and virtual reality. His recent research focuses on virtual humans to design and develop a lifelike computer interface by digitizing a real person’s figure and nature, including personality and mannerisms. Lee received his BS and MS degree in Architecture from Yonsei University, Seoul, Korea, MFA from the School of Art and Design at the University of Illinois at Chicago (UIC), and a Ph.D. in Electronic Visualization Laboratory, Computer Science at UIC.

Andrea Baldwin is an associate professor of Gender Studies at the University of Utah. Her scholarship centers on the experiences of Black women globally with a specific focus on Black feminist decoloniality, care, and Anglophone Caribbean women’s migration. Dr. Baldwin is the author of *A Decolonial Black Feminist Theory of Reading and Shade: Feeling the University* (2021), and the co-editor of *Standpoints: Black Feminist Knowledges* (2022). She has also published several journal articles, including in the *Journal of*

*International Women Studies*, *Frontiers*, *International Journal of Africana Studies*, *Wagadu*, and the *Body Studies Journal*.

Heidi Henderson, choreographer for elephant JANE dance (EJD) is a five-time recipient of the Rhode Island State Council on the Arts Choreography Fellowship. EJD has performed at the South Bank Centre in London, NYC, all over New England, Jacob’s Pillow Inside/Out Festival and The International Festival of Dance in Taegu, Korea. Heidi danced in the companies of Bebe Miller, Nina Wiener, Peter Schmitz, and Paula Josa-Jones and in works by Colleen Thomas, Sondra Loring and others. Heidi is a Professor at Connecticut College.